

MySQL Installation Guide

This guide explains how to install MySQL on **Windows** or **macOS** before the first session. Please complete the steps **before coming to class** so we can focus on queries and practice instead of setup issues.

What You Will Install

You will install:

- **MySQL Server** (the database engine)
- **MySQL Workbench** (a visual tool to write and run SQL queries)

Both are free.

For Windows Users (Link to [video](#))

There are **two ways** to install MySQL on Windows. You may use the **MySQL Installer (recommended)** or install the **MySQL Server and MySQL Workbench separately**. Both approaches work. The installer is simpler and reduces the chance of missing required components.

Option 1: Install Using MySQL Installer (Recommended)

1. Open a browser and go to the official MySQL installer page:
<https://dev.mysql.com/downloads/installer/>
2. Download **MySQL Installer for Windows**.
If available, choose the **full installer** to avoid missing components.
3. Run the installer.
If Windows asks for permission, select **Yes**.
4. When prompted to choose a setup type, select **Developer Default**.
This installs MySQL Server, MySQL Workbench, and all required tools.
5. During configuration:
 - Keep the default port (**3306**)
 - Select **Strong Password Encryption**
 - Set a **root password**
Save this password carefully. You will need it later.
6. Click **Next** and **Execute** until the installation completes.
7. Open **MySQL Workbench**.
 - You should see a connection named **Local instance MySQL**
 - Click it and enter the root password you created

Option 2: Install MySQL Server and Workbench Separately (Manual Installation)

This option is suitable if you prefer to install each component individually or if the installer does not work on your system.

1. Open a browser and go to the MySQL downloads page:
<https://dev.mysql.com/downloads/>
 2. Download **MySQL Server**:
 - Click **MySQL Server**
 - Choose the Windows version
 - Download and run the installer
 - During setup:
 - Keep port **3306**
 - Choose **Strong Password Encryption**
 - Set and save a **root password**
 3. Download **MySQL Workbench**:
 - Return to the downloads page
 - Click **MySQL Workbench**
 - Download and install it using the default settings
 4. Open **MySQL Workbench** after both installations are complete.
 - Click + to create a new connection if one is not created automatically
 - Set:
 - Hostname: `localhost`
 - Port: `3306`
 - Username: `root`
 - Click **Test Connection** and enter your root password
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For macOS Users (Link to [video](#))

1. Open a browser and go to:
<https://dev.mysql.com/downloads/mysql/>
2. Select **Operating System: macOS**.
3. Download the **DMG Archive** (the file ends with `.dmg`).
4. Open the downloaded file and follow the installer steps.
5. During installation:
 - Keep the default port (**3306**)
 - Set a **root password**
Save this password somewhere safe.
6. After installation:
 - Open **System Settings** (or System Preferences)
 - Look for **MySQL**
 - Make sure the MySQL Server status is **Running**

7. Open **MySQL Workbench**.
8. Download the **MySQL Workbench** from the following link:
<https://dev.mysql.com/downloads/workbench/>
9. Install it and then open the Workbench and try to connect with the server
 - Click **Local instance MySQL**
 - Enter the root password

If the connection opens without errors, the installation is complete.

Quick Test (macOS or Win)

To make sure everything works:

1. Open **MySQL Workbench**
2. Connect to **Local instance MySQL**
3. Click the **SQL Editor**
4. Run this command:

```
SELECT VERSION();
```

If you see a version number, your setup is working correctly.

Common Issues and Tips

- Forgetting the root password is the most common problem. Please save it.
 - If MySQL Server is not running on macOS, start it from System Settings.
 - Do not uninstall and reinstall unless instructed. Ask for help first.
 - Bring your laptop to the first lab even if you are unsure about your setup.
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Before Class Checklist

- MySQL Server installed
- MySQL Workbench installed
- Able to connect to Local instance MySQL
- Root password saved